



Figure 4: Amarok displays the song playing currently

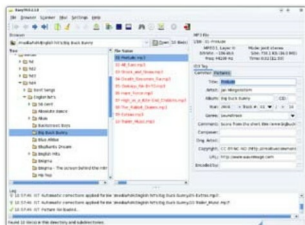


Figure 5: The EasyTag editor

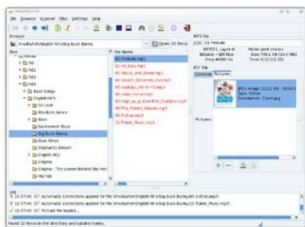


Figure 6: EasyTag's album art editor

Managing music and editing tags

The first step to managing music is to store your collection under proper directories with suitable names. Doing this will help you find or access your music without any hassle.

Whether you get your music from the Internet, from optical media, from friends or any other source, make sure you create proper folders to help you differentiate between

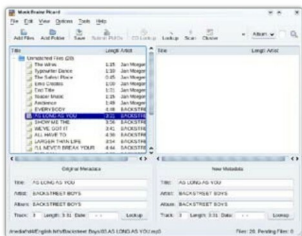


Figure 7: The Picard online tags editor from MusicBrainz



Figure 8: Amarok's cover manager

different artists and their albums. Then copy the audio files into suitable folders. Rename the audio files by track number, followed by the name of the song.

After you have stored your music systematically, it's time to move on to the next step: tagging and adding album art.

Most of the media players available for Linux come with in-built ID tag editors, but I would still recommend you use EasyTag and Picard. The editors that media players bundle, lack functionality. They allow you to edit quite a few tags, but don't allow you to edit album art. It would be great to see a full-blown ID tag editor in one of the major media players.

We will use EasyTag for general tag editing. It's a standalone tag editor with support for almost all the media formats out there—the currently supported formats are MP2, MP3, FLAC, Ogg Vorbis, Mp4/AAC, Mousepack and Monkey audio files.

EasyTag has a very intuitive interface (Figure 5). On the left-hand side you will notice the browser pane, with which you can navigate your collection. The centre portion lists all the music/audio files available in the folder that you select